

Report conversation

I have this simple golang program:

```
// You can edit this code!  
// Click here and start typing.  
package main  
  
import "fmt"  
  
func main() {  
    fmt.Println("Hello, 世界")  
    s := `  
    abc  
    def  
    123  
    456  
    `  
    fmt.Println(s)  
}
```

I want to avoid doing this:

```
s := `  
abc  
def  
123  
456  
`
```

Because it's hard to read.

Is there a golang strings helper that'll strip the preceding spaces so I maintain readability in the source code?

Yes, Go provides a way to handle this situation neatly. You can use the `strings` package, specifically the `TrimLeft` function or similar variants, to strip the preceding spaces from each line. This will allow you to maintain readability in the source code while avoiding unwanted leading spaces in the string.

Here's how you can modify your program:

go

 Copy code

```
package main

import (
    "fmt"
    "strings"
)

func main() {
    fmt.Println("Hello, 世界")

    // Multiline string with leading spaces for readability
    rawString := `
        abc
        def
        123
        456
    `

    // Split the string into lines
    lines := strings.Split(rawString, "\n")

    // Trim leading spaces from each line
    for i, line := range lines {
        lines[i] = strings.TrimLeft(line, " \t")
    }

    // Join the lines back into a single string
    cleanString := strings.Join(lines, "\n")
}
```

```
    fmt.Println(cleanString)
}
```

In this example:

- `strings.Split` is used to divide the string into lines.
- `strings.TrimSpace` removes leading spaces and tabs from each line.
- `strings.Join` reassembles the lines into a single string.

This approach keeps your source code readable while ensuring the output string doesn't contain unwanted leading spaces.

Can you move it into a small helper called `trimString` such that I can do `rawString := trimString(...)`

Certainly! You can create a small helper function named `trimString` that takes a multiline string as input and returns a new string with leading spaces removed from each line. Here's how you can define and use this function in your Go program:

go

 Copy code

```
package main
```

```
import (  
    "fmt"  
    "strings"  
)
```

```
// trimString removes leading spaces from each line in a multiline string
```

```
func trimString(s string) string {  
    lines := strings.Split(s, "\n")  
    for i, line := range lines {  
        lines[i] = strings.TrimSpace(line)  
    }  
    return strings.Join(lines, "\n")  
}
```

```
func main() {
```

```
fmt.Println("Hello, 世界")

// Multiline string with leading spaces
rawString := trimString(`
    abc
    def
    123
    456
`)

fmt.Println(rawString)
}
```

In this program:

- The `trimString` function takes a multiline string, splits it into lines, trims the leading spaces from each line, and then rejoins the lines into a single string.
- In `main`, you can now simply call `trimString` with your raw string literal. The returned string will have all leading spaces removed from each line.